28. Community and education — organising, deciding, teaching and preserving knowledge

Oracle OS guide. Manuals in the library: "Robert's Rules of Order", McGuffey Readers (reading and writing), Gutenberg (arithmetic, geometry), "50-year plan", Wikipedia/Wikibooks in Oracle.

A group's first 30 days

1. **Count people and skills**: list with name, age, health, trades (doctor, nurse, farmer, mechanic, teacher, cook, carpenter...).
2. **Common inventory**: water, food (days per person), medicines, tools, seeds, fuel.
3. **Priorities**: clean water → sanitation → shelter/heat → food → health → security → communication.
4. **Rotas**: water, firewood, cooking, watch, care of children/elderly/sick — everyone contributes according to ability.
5. **Simple written rules posted publicly**, approved by the assembly.

Making decisions

- Regular **assembly** (weekly) with an agenda, a chair and a secretary who records decisions in a book.
- Practical rule (simplified Robert's Rules): motion → someone seconds → time-limited debate where everyone speaks once before anyone speaks twice → vote → record. For serious matters, a 2/3 majority.
- Seek consensus in small groups; vote when there is none.
- **Rotate roles** with short terms (3–6 months); public accounting of the common inventory.
- **Resolving conflict**: first a talk between the parties; then a neutral mediator; then a council of 3–5 people chosen by lot or election. Proportionate, restorative sanctions (community work, restitution); expulsion is the last resort.
- Written basic rights: nobody is denied water, minimum food or medical care; children are protected; no corporal punishment; equality before the rules.

Economy without money

- Record of trades and hours worked (time bank), common store with goods in/out written down.
- Reserves for winter and bad harvests: keep 1 year of seed and, if possible, 1 year of grain.
- Agreed standard measures (weight, volume, length) kept in a public place.

Public health

- Latrines away from water, handwashing, boil/filter water, control rats and flies, isolate contagious patients (see Medicine and Natural building).
- Register of births, deaths, illnesses and vaccinations.

School

- Teach **everyone** to read, write and count — it is what preserves everything else. Classes by level, not age; advanced pupils teach the others.
- Minimum curriculum: reading/writing (McGuffey, primers), arithmetic and measures, practical geometry (areas, angles, 3-4-5 square), science (water, health, soil, plants, animals, simple chemistry), local history and geography, trades (apprenticeship with masters), first aid, ethics and living together.
- Materials: slates + chalk, wax tablets, charcoal, handmade paper; teach outdoors with sticks and stones (counting, fractions, geometry).
- **Apprenticeships**: each trade has masters and apprentices; the apprentice writes what they learn in the trade's notebook.
- Ceremonies and stories: songs, tales and festival calendars keep cohesion and memory.

Preserving knowledge

- Oracle is the library, but **paper is the backup**: print/hand-copy the Print pack and keep it in 2–3 dry, separate places.
- "Living library": each person responsible for studying and teaching 1–2 areas.
- Copyists: recopy decaying texts; keep a central index.
- Annual group history record (what happened, what was learned, harvests, weather).